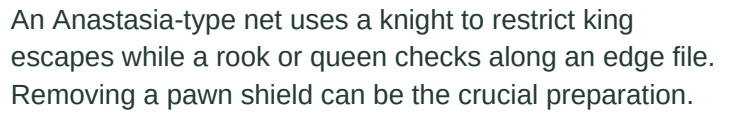


Anastasia mating nets

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Locate the knight's controlled flight squares and the heavy piece's checking line. Follow how the combination opens that line.

The defending king is on h1. Absolute pin: pawn on h2.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21...Rxb2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on b2. Recorded reply: **22.Kxb2**.

22...Rh8# Mate: rook on h8 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h2. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

The knight is often a supporting piece rather than the final checker. Do not overlook its quiet control of escape squares.